
Direct Access & Public Access Scheme

The Direct Access and Public Access schemes enable clients to instruct a barrister at Gordon & Co Legal Services **without first engaging a solicitor**, where appropriate. This offers swift, cost-effective access to specialist legal advice and representation. See [Bar Standards Board's Public Access Guidance](#) for Lay Clients. This will help you to understand how the Public Access scheme works, and explains how you can use it to instruct barristers directly.

Public Access Rules

Our barristers who undertake Public Access work have completed the required training. Gordon & Co Legal Services may accept suitable instructions for advisory work, drafting and advocacy, subject to the exclusions set out below and an assessment of each case. We suggest that you read all of the information on this page about Public Access before contacting us by phone, email or by using our online form to discuss your case.

We also recommend that you read the following:

- [Bar Council – Instructing a Barrister](#)
- [Bar Standards Board Public Access Guidance For Lay Clients](#)

Have a Query?

For guidance or to discuss whether your family law matter is suitable for Direct or Public Access, please contact Gordon & Co Legal Services by completing the **enquiry form**.

What Our Barristers Can Do for You

Under the Direct and Public Access schemes, our barristers are qualified to:

- Provide expert legal advice on the merits and likely outcomes of your case
- Draft correspondence
- Assist with drafting statements from litigants and witnesses
- Prepare formal court documents
- Advise on the selection of suitable expert witnesses
- Draft instructions for experts
- Outline the procedural steps required in your matter

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- Support you in attempts to resolve your dispute
 - Represent you in court or before a tribunal

Our role remains that of specialist legal adviser and advocate. As such, certain tasks must remain with you or, in some cases, with a solicitor.

What We Cannot Do Under These Schemes

Barristers at Gordon & Co Legal Services cannot:

- Issue proceedings
- Serve documents on other parties
- File correspondence or documents with the court
- Contact witnesses or investigate evidence
- Instruct expert witnesses on your behalf
- Correspond directly with the other side or the court on your behalf

If at any stage we believe that instructing a solicitor is necessary for your best interests, we will recommend suitable options.

Fees & Payment

We accept Direct and Public Access instructions on a **privately funded basis only**, with payment required in advance of work being undertaken.

Our fees vary depending on:

- The complexity of your case
- The urgency and volume of work
- The seniority of counsel
- Whether the work is advisory or involves representation

We provide fees on either:

- **An hourly rate**, or
- **A fixed fee** (brief fee/refresher), plus VAT where applicable

You will receive:

- A **clear, written quote** before instructing us
- A **transparent breakdown** of anticipated key stages and timescales
- **No charges** for any work not expressly agreed in advance

If, after receiving our pricing and terms, you decide not to proceed, we will return your documents at no cost.

You can learn more about the Direct Access Scheme on the [Bar Council website here](#)
You can read the [Bar Council's Guidance for Lay Clients here](#)
You can read the rules relating to the [Direct Access Scheme here](#)